MIL-C-44340(GL)
29 June 1988

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CAN, TRAY PACK

This specification is approved for use by the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This document covers the requirements for a new metal Tray Pack can made of tin free steel. This can is suitable for packaging all Tray Pack menu items.

1.2 Classification. The can shall be of the following styles (see 6.1):

Style 1 - Plain
  a. Body
  b. Lid
Style 2 - Ribbed
  a. Body
  b. Lid

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8110

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-203	-	Paper, Kraft, Untreated
TT-C-495	-	Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497	-	Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078	-	Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of specifications, standards, and handbooks required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

(Copies of drawings, publications, and other Government documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Copies should be obtained from the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 2200 Mill Road, Alexandria, VA 22314.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Copies should be obtained from the Uniform Classification Committee, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Suite 1120, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Can materials. All materials shall conform with 21 CFR Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act as amended and regulations promulgated thereunder (see 6.2).

3.1.1 Tin free steel. The can shall be constructed of tin free steel (also known as electrolytic chromium-coated steel). The steel shall be of sufficient temper and hardness to protect food product during shipment and storage. The nominal metallic chromium thickness shall be equivalent to 5 mg/ft^2 of surface, covered by chromium oxide film containing 0.7 mg/ft^2 to 2.5 mg/ft^2 of metallic chromium. The base plate weight of the can body and can lids shall be 90 pounds per base box. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with these requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.1.2 Interior can coating. The entire inside area of the can shall be double coated. The enamel used shall conform with the provisions of the Code of Federal Regulations, Food, and Drugs Title 21, Chapter 1, Subpart C - Food Additives, Section 175.300, Resinous and Polymeric Coatings. Scratches or fractures shall not penetrate through the interior can coating. The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The interior can coating shall neither affect nor be affected by the packaged product. A certificate of conformance shall be furnished to certify compliance with the interior can coating requirements.

3.1.3 Exterior can coating. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I or type III of TT-C-495 (see 6.1).

3.2 Can design and fabrication. The can shall be a 1001 by 1206 by 200 size can in accordance with figures 1, 2, and 3. The can shall have a capacity of approximately 105 fluid ounces. The design of body and lid shall be plain or ribbed style (see 6.1). The curl of the lids shall be compound-lined in preparation for the double seaming operation. The seaming compound shall comply with commercial standards. The compound shall be of adequate amount and adherence and placed properly so that it forms a tight seal but will not be squeezed internally into the food. The lid and body shall be capable of achieving a double seam thereby creating a hermetic seal. The cans shall be fabricated using methods that reflect good standards of workmanship and quality in the finished product.

3.2.1 Plain style, (style 1).

3.2.1.1 Body. The bottom of the body shall incorporate a minimum of two rectangular reinforcing beads (see figure 1). The apex of the beads shall be outward. The sides shall be reinforced with beads and corner flutes. The apex of these beads shall be inward.

3.2.1.2 Lid. The lid shall incorporate corner beads (see figure 1). The apex of the beads shall be outward. There shall be one expansion panel with a smooth area, approximately 8-7/8 inches in length and 6-5/8 inches in width, to accommodate the required can labeling.

3.2.2 Ribbed style, (style 2).

3.2.2.1 Body. The body design shall be reinforced on the bottom with six longitudinal beads or ribs 0.050 $\pm$ 0.010 inches deep (see figure 2). The beads shall be 9 inches by 3/4 inch in length and width and shall be equidistant in the center panel of the bottom. The apex of the beads shall be outward. The sides shall be reinforced with beads and corner flutes. The apex of these beads shall be inward.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.2.2 Lid. The lid design shall be reinforced with eight longitudinal beads 0.018 ± 0.004 inches deep (see figure 2). The beads shall be 11 inches by 3/4 inch in length and width and shall be equidistant in the center panel of the lid. The center four beads on the lid design shall be interrupted to provide a 5-inch by 5-inch flat center panel for labeling. The apex of these beads shall be outward.

3.3 Can condition. The can bodies and lids shall be clean. There shall be no dirt or stains on the cans. If the cans are coated with oil, there shall be no excessive oil present.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificates of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted the Government reserves the right to inspect such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.2.2 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects specified in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in units of can bodies or can lids, and the sample unit shall be one can body or one can lid. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.0.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. End item defects

Category		Defect
Major		
101		Not style specified
102		Scratch or fracture in interior coating
103		Peel or blister of interior coating
104		Entire inner surface not coated
105		Reinforcing beads not as specified
106		Label panel not as specified (lid only)
107		Dents, scratches
108		Dirty, stained
109		Inadequate or excessive amount of seaming compound (lid only)
110		Seaming compound not of adequate adherence (lid only)
111		Seaming compound not properly placed (lid only)

4.2.3 External can coating examination. Examination of the external can coating shall be in accordance with TT-C-495.

4.2.4 Packaging examination. The cans and shipping containers shall be examined for the defects specified in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in shipping containers, and the sample unit shall be one filled shipping container. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

TABLE II. Packaging defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Interior packing with kraft paper not as specified
102		Number of cans or lids not as specified
	201	Excessive oil on cans
	202	Cans are dirty or stained
	203	Box not snug-fitting.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing. Can bodies and lids shall be packed separately. Bodies shall be nested 22 per shipping container with a sheet of kraft paper in accordance with A-A-203, placed between each body. The stack of bodies shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The dimensions of the box shall be 12-3/4 inches in length, 10-5/8 inches in width, and 15-3/8 inches in depth. Lids shall be nested 90 per shipping container. The stack of lids shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The dimensions of the box shall be 13 inches in length, 10-5/8 inches in width, and 6-1/2 inches in depth.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. Style of body required (see 1.2 and 3.2).
c. Style of lid required (see 1.2 and 3.2).
d. Type of exterior can coating required (see 3.1.3).

6.2 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of the specification or regulation (see 3.1).

6.3 Subject term (key word) listing.

Can
Tray Pack

Custodian:

Army - GL

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, SA
Air Force - 50
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8110-A289

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

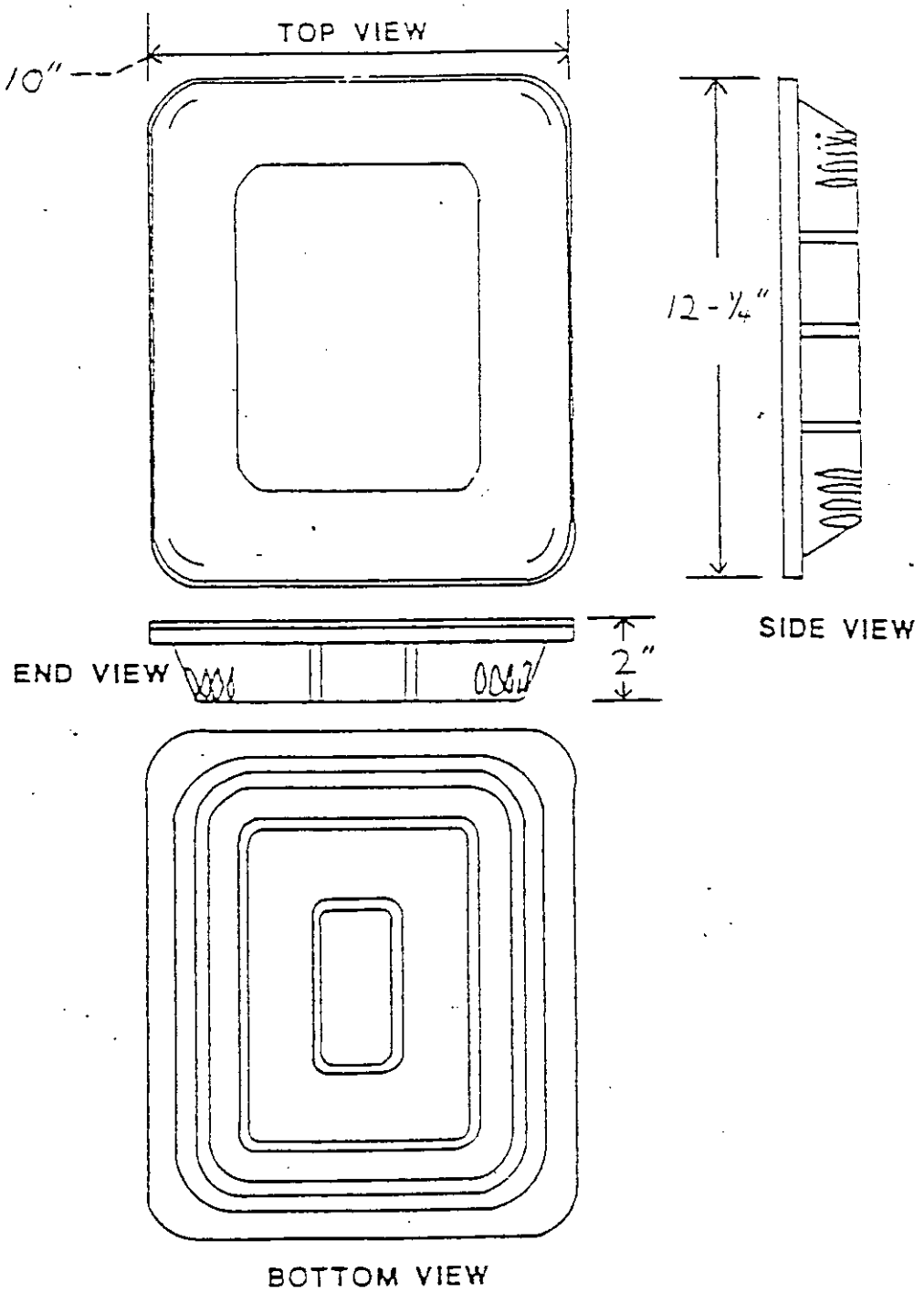


Figure 1. Style 1 - Tray Pack Food Container

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

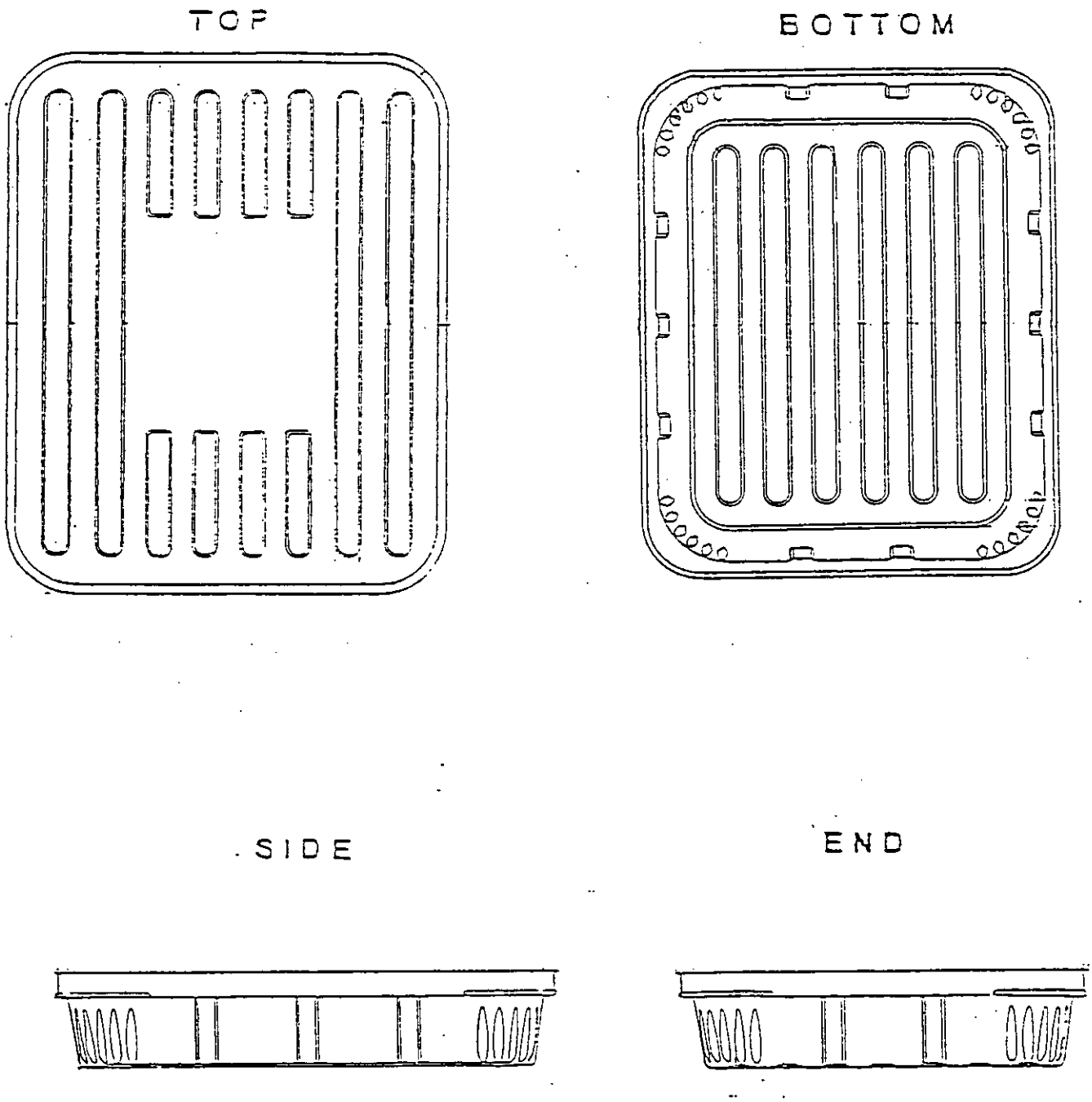


Figure 2. Style 2 - Tray Pack Food Container

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

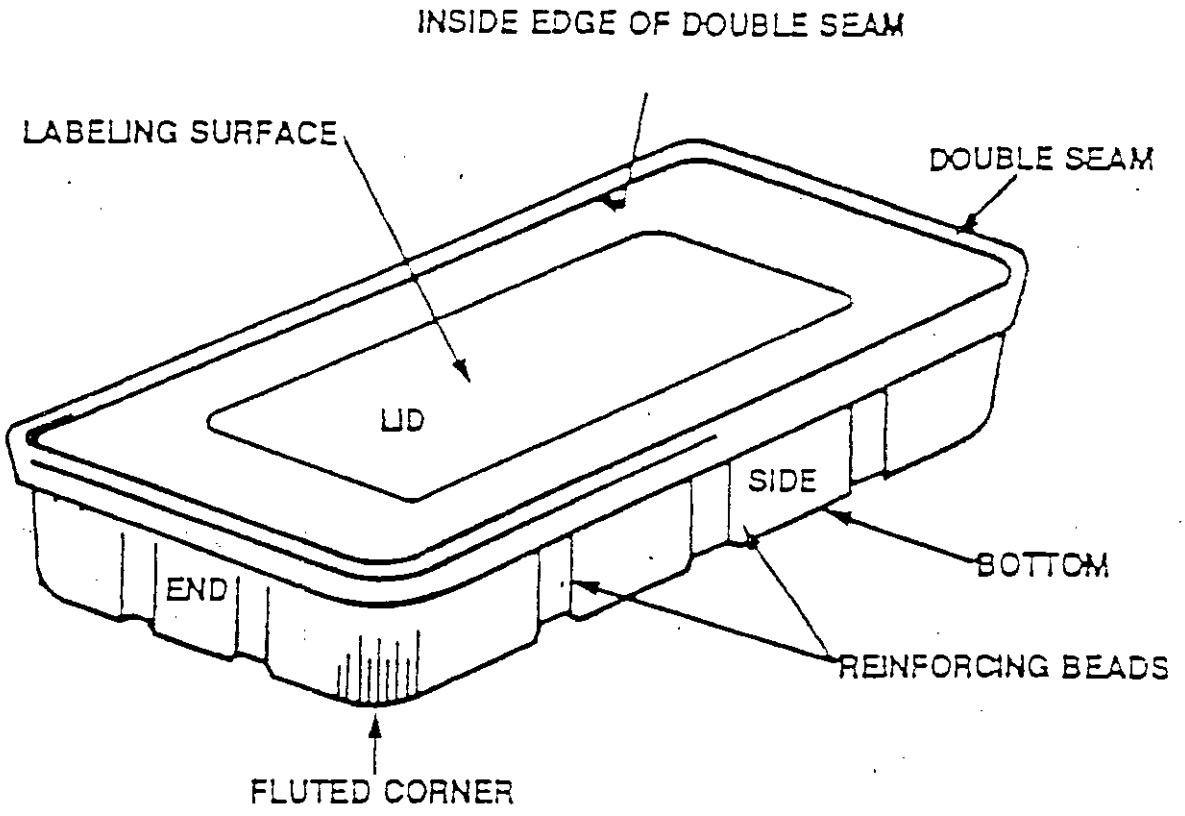


Figure 3. Tray Pack Can Nomenclature

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT
and ENGINEERING CENTER
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Natick, MA 01760-5014

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

NO POSTAGE
NECESSARY
IF MAILED
IN THE
UNITED STATES

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 12062 WASHINGTON D. C.

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

Commander
U.S. Army Natick Research, Development
and Engineering Center
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Natick, MA 01760-5014

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T01:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-44340(GL)	CAN, TRAY PACK

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE. NATICK/OP1 Feb 86

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22101:34Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.